

TASK 5A: CASE STUDY

Scam UPI Payment Request

What is UPI FRAUD?

The most common form of cybercrime involving UPI is when the attacker succeeds in conning the user into sending money rather than receiving it. This usually occurs when the person is well versed in the use of digital transactions but not fully knowledgeable about the modus operandi of the attackers.

STEP BY STEP PROCEDURE:

The process usually begins when a student, Riya, posts an advertisement online for the sale of her old headphones. Shortly after this, she receives a call from a person who claims to be interested in purchasing the headphones without any negotiation. The person claims to send the money in advance for the headphones.

The process of the crime in this case is as follows:

1. The attacker gains the trust of the person by showing interest in the headphones and talking confidently.
2. The attacker sends the person a Collect Request rather than money via the UPI app.
3. The person is asked to enter her UPI PIN to receive the money.
4. The person unknowingly approves the payment by entering her PIN, sending money to the attacker.

TARGET VICTIMS:

In such cases, the victims are mostly students or small vendors who use online platforms and may not be aware of the difference between sending and receiving a request.

CONSEQUENCES:

The consequences of such scams include the loss of money and the feeling of panic in the moment. Moreover, there is the risk of further fraud. In such cases, people may also lose faith in the online payment system. This is another case where misunderstanding and trusting the wrong person can be a threat.